

Past Simple

CEFR A2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The past simple describes finished actions at a finished time. Use it for:

- 1 Completed actions in the past — I visited Rome last year.
- 2 A sequence of past events — She woke up, made coffee and left.
- 3 Past habits and states — We lived in Girona for ten years.

Regular verbs add -ed (worked); irregular verbs change form (go → went). For an experience with no specific time, use the present perfect instead.

At a glance

Form	Structure	Example
Affirmative	subject + past form (verb + -ed , or irregular)	She finished the report. / We went home.
Negative	subject + didn't + base verb	They didn't arrive on time.
Question	Did + subject + base verb?	Did you see it?

Learning objectives

- Can form affirmative, negative and interrogative past simple sentences with regular and irregular verbs (CEFR A2).
- Can spell regular past forms correctly (-ed, -ied, consonant doubling).
- Can distinguish the past simple from the present perfect using time markers.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Past Simple · CEFR A2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. We ____ a great film last night.

- A. watch
- B. watched
- C. watches
- D. were watching

2. She ____ to Paris in 2019.

- A. goed
- B. went
- C. gone
- D. going

3. They ____ the message.

- A. didn't saw
- B. didn't see
- C. don't saw
- D. not saw

4. ____ you ____ the news this morning?

- A. Did / hear
- B. Did / heard
- C. Do / heard
- D. Have / hear

5. I ____ him at the station yesterday.

- A. have seen
- B. saw
- C. has seen
- D. see

6. He ____ a new car last month.

- A. buyed
- B. bought
- C. buy
- D. buys

7. The past simple of 'study' is ____.

- A. studied
- B. studied
- C. studed
- D. studies

8. We ____ in Girona when we were children.

- A. live
- B. lived
- C. have lived
- D. are living

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'It's ten years since I last saw her.'

- A. I last saw her ten years ago.
- B. I haven't seen her for ten years ago.
- C. I have seen her ten years ago.
- D. I didn't see her ten years ago.

10. When the phone rang, I ____ it immediately.

- A. was answering
- B. answered
- C. answer
- D. have answered

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. watched** — Regular verbs add -ed in the past simple: 'watched'. 'Last night' signals a finished time.
2. **B. went** — 'Go' is irregular: its past simple form is 'went'.
3. **B. didn't see** — Negatives use didn't + base verb: 'didn't see'. 'Did' already carries the past.
4. **A. Did / hear** — Past questions use Did + subject + base verb: 'Did you hear...?'.
5. **B. saw** — A finished-time expression like 'yesterday' always takes the past simple: 'saw'.
6. **B. bought** — 'Buy' is irregular: the past simple is 'bought'.
7. **B. studied** — Consonant + -y becomes -ied: study → studied.
8. **B. lived** — A past state that is now finished uses the past simple: 'lived'.
9. **A. I last saw her ten years ago.** — 'It's ten years since I last saw her' = 'I last saw her ten years ago' — a finished action with 'ago' takes the past simple.
10. **B. answered** — Two completed past actions in sequence (rang, then answered) both take the past simple.